

TO: Honorable Mayor and City Council

FROM: Pat McGinnis, City Manager

SUBJECT: Portage Road Lake Center Corridor Reconstruction Project – Phase 1

SUPPORTING PERSONNEL: Peter Dame, Chief Development Officer
Kendra Gwin, Director of Transportation & Utilities

ACTION RECOMMENDED: Take action to:

- a. Award a construction contract to Brenner Excavating of Hopkins, Michigan, for the Portage Road Reconstruction project for an amount not to exceed \$4,477,268.10;
- b. Amend a contract with Wightman in the amount of \$721,600 to provide construction engineering and right-of-way services for the Portage Road Reconstruction project;

and authorize the City Manager to execute all documents related to the contract on behalf of the city.

The Fiscal Year 2025-2026 Capital Improvement Program budget includes funding for the Portage Road Lake Center Corridor Project Phase 1 reconstruction from Bacon Avenue to Lakeview Drive. The Portage Road Lake Center Corridor is an important area within the City of Portage. Portage Road is a major arterial street that serves as a connection between residential, industrial and commercial areas. The vision that was approved by City Council on July 13, 2021, of a more attractive, multimodal Portage Road anchored by the Lake Center Corridor was the starting point of the design. The previous corridor level planning effort was expanded and reinforced by a nearly year-long public engagement and design process during 2025 called Portage Road 360. This proactive design for the future of the Portage Road Lake Center Corridor will benefit the community, property owners and area businesses and promote a more vibrant district. This project is intended as the first phase of a multi-year improvement effort to create a safer, more attractive, and promotes multiple modes of transportation.

On September 10, 2024, City Council approved a contract with Wightman for the design engineering of the Portage Road Lake Center Corridor Project from East Osterhout Avenue to East Centre Avenue, which will be reconstructed in phases. After extensive public outreach, the design for Phase 1 was finalized for bidding. During the design process, it was determined that starting the construction of Phase 1 at Lancelot Court south of Bacon Avenue would make a smoother transition point. On December 18, 2025, three bids were received with the low bid being submitted by Brenner Excavating in the amount of \$5,638,702.40, which was higher than the engineer's estimate and budget. City staff and Wightman met with Brenner Excavating and were able to scale the project back to the original budgeted location just south of the Bacon Avenue intersection.

As their original contract was only for design engineering services, Wightman has submitted a proposal

for construction engineering and right-of-way services for Phase 1 in the amount not to exceed \$721,600. Staff has reviewed the proposal and found it to be appropriate for the work to be completed. Phase 1 of the project includes installation of a three-lane road section with curb and gutter, complete storm sewer system, a 10-foot trail on the east side of the road, a 5-foot sidewalk on the west side, sewer leads to unserved properties, and traffic signals at the intersections of Woodbine Avenue and South Shore Drive. If awarded the project, construction is planned to begin in April 2026 and is expected to be completed by November 2026.

It is recommended that City Council award a construction contract to Brenner Excavating of Hopkins, Michigan for the Portage Road Reconstruction project in an amount not to exceed \$4,477,268.10, amend the contract with Wightman by an amount not to exceed \$721,600 for construction engineering and right-of-way services, and authorize the City Manager to execute all documents related to the contract on behalf of the city.

FUNDING: Sufficient funds are available in the 2025-2026 Capital Improvement Program.

Attachments:

1. Portage Road Reconstruction Bid Tabulation
2. Wightman Construction Engineering and Right-of-Way Services Proposal